

A sonnet by ten in the morning

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Poiesis

THE DAILY LETTER · NO. 214

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Good morning, Niko,

Two hundred and ten years ago next month, a twenty-year-old walked home through London at dawn with a poem forming in his head. He had spent the night reading someone else's translation of someone else's poem. By ten o'clock the sonnet was finished.

*Then felt I like some watcher of the skies
When a new planet swims into his ken...*

Five muses are waiting for you today:

- John Keats, a sonnet
- Caravaggio, a painting in a Roman chapel
- Henry James, on the ten words that became a novel
- Van Gogh, a letter written before sunrise
- Rublev, an icon made by imitation

Before you read what anyone else thought, leave your own first impression. How does the muse call to your own experience? What do you hear it singing?



Today's five stickers leave at midnight. Each impression you leave unlocks one to choose from; leave all five and yours comes gilded.

Open today's muses

See you at the table.

One letter a day at 7:00 · None on Sundays: the seventh day is fallow
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